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L02 Reflection Journal

As a complete beginner at coding, everything I saw in this lab was quite overwhelming. So many words, terms, variables, and numbers that I did not understand what they meant. Given I was clueless to anything that involved coding, I genuinely thought that everything was coded from scratch. If you wanted data on something, you had to look for information from reliable sources. However, I got to learn that there are libraries that simplify the task to obtain and can even be used for practice. I was also surprised by the number of requisites needed for a program to function and how easily accessible Google Colab is, its accessibility and easy use facilitated my experience. I also was not familiar with what GitHub is. Upon learning its purpose, I find it very useful and efficient. I still have a lot to learn about it. Now that I understood where the numbers of the data come from, I thought I would have to take care of naming the variables and categorizing the numbers in the right dataset, but I was wrong. Along with the numbers came the classes, the features that we would focus on for the lab, and the quantity of samples ready to be used for our code. Another thing I learned was how to call the tools to use them in coding. The keyword for this is 'import', which to my little knowledge in the field, shouldn't be used as a keyword since that would activate a syntax error. Something else that was very helpful as well was the math section, by using the 'np.numpy', instead of having to take care of summing up every sample within their respective class and dividing it by 50 for one of the species and

repeating the process two more times, I can just use the function I mentioned. The task is simplified than having to do everything by hand, same goes with the standard deviation. This lab overall is helpful for practice. Having the codes written out and looking at sources to better understand parts of the code and testing them out is a great learning experience and opportunity to grow confident in machine learning and coding.